

government is making a laudable effort to regulate e-waste by setting a floor price for the electronics industry to pay to recyclers who manage the waste, despite resistance from the companies. However, given that e-waste is a global problem, India could go further and take on global leadership, not just over who bears the costs of recycling, but also upstream questions like better design and sustainable products. These questions are not only about sustainability but also create opportunities by opening the market for innovation in design.

The AI industry creates jobs in the short term. Skilled Indian graduates fuel a lucrative industry in data labelling, in which they clean and label data needed to train AI. While this is temporarily gainful employment, the hours and conditions are famously exploitative. Unlike their parents, who may have risen slowly in bank or government jobs, these graduates are in an industry in which they have no gradual growth and no pension. Worryingly, the law does nothing to protect them from falling prey to misleading job advertisements through which they are lured into these roles, expecting career growth as engineers, not stagnation as job workers. First-generation professionals trying to achieve the Indian dream through education and hard work fall victim to this since they have

TAKEAWAYS

- **India needs to make governance choices that will protect Indians as the global AI industry turns to us for its needs**
- **Strong data and consumer protection laws are crucial; Indians are vulnerable to Generative AI chatbots**
- **Ideas from India's complex, diverse society can supercharge its bid for global AI policy leadership status**

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS / AI**